playing hard ball all the way. . . . [In the afternoon] an N.S.C. meeting getting ready for the Soviet foreign minister's visit and how we treat the Daniloff problem with him. We've notified the Soviet U. we're sending 25 of their UN staff home. All are KGB agents.

Sept. 18

. . . During the day we were receiving bulletins about the Daniloff case. Gorbachev has gone on TV to declare our man is definitely a spy. I have told him in writing twice he is not. Shevardnadze has arrived to meet with George Shultz. Whether I see him or not is up in the air. Gen. Sec. of UN has stated our action in ordering 25 of UN Soviet staff out of the country is against UN charter. He'd better be careful, if we cut off UN allowance they might be out of business. Back to the W.H. and so to bed. . . .

Last night Sen. confirmed my two Supreme Court nominees, Rehnquist and Scalia.

The next day, George Shultz brought Soviet Foreign Minister Eduard Shevardnadze to the White House to deliver a reply from Gorbachev to my letter. When Shevardnadze arrived in the Oval Office, he discovered he didn't have the letter and had left it by mistake at the Soviet embassy. Several KGB agents who were traveling with him left and when they returned half an hour later with the letter they started to enter the Oval Office. Our Secret Service agents said, "Well, no, you can't do that, we don't allow KGB agents to walk into the Oval Office," and they let out a protest. Finally, after considerable commotion (I learned later), there was a compromise: The Soviet interpreter was called over to the door of the Oval Office and a KGB agent handed him the letter, and the interpreter handed it to Shevardnadze, who handed it to me.